

WINDING CREEKS

A typical salt marsh is a patchwork of winding creeks, muddy pools, and dense patches of specialized salt marsh plants. At high tide, the pools and creeks fill up with saltwater, which drains away at low tide to leave shining wet mud.

► NATURAL PATTERN

This view from the air shows the complex network of creeks and pools that carries water in and out of the salt marsh.



SALTY HAVENS

Remote salt marshes make ideal habitats for animals. They include insects and snails, which are eaten by frogs and small mammals. These in turn are hunted by snakes and foxes. Fish and other marine animals visit at high tide, while at low tide the muddy pools and creeks attract flocks of shorebirds.

◄ DAZZLING FLOCK

On some warmer salt marshes, such as the Camargue in southern France, the waters support flocks of flamingos. They wade through the shallow water in their search for prey.

WOW!

In North America, up to 75 percent of the fish that are caught for food rely on salt marshes as nurseries for their young.

